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AP[®] European History

COURSE AND EXAM DESCRIPTION

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Sample Exam Questions

The sample exam questions that follow illustrate the relationship between the course framework and the AP European History Exam and serve as examples of the types of questions that appear on the exam. After the sample questions is a table that shows to which skill and learning objective(s) each question relates. The table also provides the answers to the multiple-choice questions.

Section I

PART A: MULTIPLE-CHOICE

Questions 1–4 refer to the passage below.

“It is not right when some make the simple folk believe that diligent confession and a worldly gift grants a papal indulgence and that thereby they can attain the forgiveness of sins. For the clink of the coin that falls into the money box will not free the sinner of his sins. Forgiveness requires first and above all else a truly contrite heart. Also, it is beyond doubt that the person may attain forgiveness of his sins by a true, honest contrition even without all the indulgences that he can avail himself of. But it is incredible and without any basis to attain pardon of sins even with papal grace if there is not first a true, heartfelt contrition over sins. . . . It is also the greatest foolishness to think sins may be greater than God’s mercy. The mercy of God is without measure and infinitely great. No one who seeks it will be denied it.”

Johannes von Staupitz, Catholic theologian and dean of the faculty at the University of Wittenberg, sermon, 1516

1. Which of the following best describes the main claim made by von Staupitz in the passage?
 - (A) Church authorities are the best judges of whether someone is truly repentant.
 - (B) The collection of money for the forgiveness of sins has corrupted the church.
 - (C) Forgiveness of sins depends on repentance, not on a monetary payment.
 - (D) Bishops, rather than the pope, should have the power to forgive sins.
2. The passage best reflects which of the following developments of the early sixteenth century?
 - (A) The rejection of Protestant ideas by members of the Catholic hierarchy
 - (B) The beginning of Europeans’ self-identification with national and ethnic groups
 - (C) The questioning of established Catholic Church doctrine
 - (D) The attempt to restrict access to new ideas made available by the printing press

3. Based on the passage and the historical context in which it was published, which of the following would most likely have challenged the author's assertions?
- (A) Protestant reformers, such as Martin Luther
 - (B) Catholic authorities, such as the pope
 - (C) Secular authorities, such as the German princes
 - (D) Radical religious groups, such as the Anabaptists
4. The controversy over the power to forgive sins referred to in the passage contributed to which of the following results in Europe over the next century?
- (A) Widespread rejection of organized religion by Europeans
 - (B) Establishment of state-sponsored Catholic churches in most of Europe
 - (C) Religious violence and the end of Catholic authority over much of the continent
 - (D) Abandonment by the papacy of claims to spiritual authority over Christians

Questions 5–7 refer to the table below.

**INDEXED COMPARISON OF WAGE LEVELS FOR STONEMASONS
AND PRICE LEVELS FOR WHEAT IN ANTWERP**

Years	Wages	Wheat Prices
1491–1500	100	100
1500–1513	100	92
1514–1520	114	102
1521–1542	128	156
1544–1556	172	199
1561–1574	300	290
1580–1592	514	515
1594–1600	600	596

Source: Adapted from C. Verlinden, J. Craeybeckx, and E. Scholliers, "Price and Wage Movements in Belgium in the Sixteenth Century" from *Economy and Society in Early Modern Europe: Essays from Annales*, Routledge & Kegan Paul, London, 1972, p. 74.

5. Based on the relationship between wages and prices shown in the table, in which period were living conditions for Antwerp stonemasons likely the most difficult?
- (A) 1500–1513
(B) 1521–1542
(C) 1561–1574
(D) 1594–1600
6. The trends in wages and prices shown in the table were most directly the result of which of the following?
- (A) The continuing negative effects of the plague and other diseases on urban populations
(B) The development and growth of the money economy
(C) The transfer of New World food crops to Europe
(D) The institution of mercantilist economic policies
7. Which of the following would indicate a limitation of the data as a basis for conclusions about the effect of economic changes on sixteenth-century workers?
- (A) Wheat was the most important agricultural product in most Europeans' diets in the sixteenth century.
(B) Antwerp remained under Habsburg imperial control during the Dutch war for independence.
(C) The Antwerp stonemasons' guild was unusually powerful and was frequently able to bargain successfully for higher wages.
(D) Wages and prices increased significantly more in the sixteenth century than they had in the previous century.

Questions 8–11 refer to the passage below.

“Foreign trade can bring great wealth, but it also exposes us to great risks. The domestic economy of a state is its real treasure. For Spain, foreign trade has become a great chain binding us to vast overseas territories. Rather than worry daily about their preservation, we must pay greater attention to those certain sources of wealth in our domestic economy. We lost Flanders, we lost Italy, so why could we not lose Mexico and Peru? Little Prussia has given the world a surprising example of what a medium-sized kingdom can do on its own. . . .

It is necessary to inform the people of the motives for a law, and of the evils the law seeks to avoid or the benefits it seeks to provide. This is especially true in monarchies in which the people have no part of legislative authority. The true measure of good laws is the extent to which they apply equally to all citizens. Happy is the kingdom whose ruler is governed by the maxims of justice and who can balance sovereign authority with civil liberty. Happy the king who realizes that political oppression is bad for the longevity of the state and that mutual confidence and unity between citizens cannot be established if the relationship between rulers and the ruled is akin to that between masters and slaves.”

Letter by an anonymous Spanish government official to the
Count of Llerena, Spain's minister of finance, 1789

8. The author's mention of Prussia as an example for Spain most likely refers to which of the following?
- (A) Prussia's dynastic union with Brandenburg, which was similar to Castile's dynastic union with Aragon
 - (B) Prussia's diplomatic maneuvering during the Thirty Years' War, which had enabled it to expand its territory
 - (C) Prussia's success in eighteenth-century conflicts such as the Seven Years' War, which occurred despite its lack of significant overseas colonies
 - (D) Prussia's emergence as an early leader in industrialization among German states, which resulted in the establishment of the Zollverein
9. The author's statement in the first paragraph concerning Spain's relationship with its colonies in the Americas is most likely influenced by which of the following late-eighteenth-century developments?
- (A) The emergence of new economic ideas challenging mercantilist theory and practice
 - (B) The outbreak of armed rebellions in Spanish colonies calling for national independence
 - (C) The formulation of new models of political representation based on the idea of the social contract

10. Based on the second paragraph, the author can best be described as advocating for Spain to adopt the principles of
- (A) Enlightened absolutism
 - (B) representative government
 - (C) free trade
 - (D) divine-right monarchy
11. Which of the following best describes the most significant effect during the Napoleonic Wars of the ideas expressed in the passage?
- (A) They made Spaniards more willing to embrace the Enlightenment principles embodied in Napoleon's policies.
 - (B) They made Spaniards more determined to fight for the preservation of their colonial empire in the Americas.
 - (C) They strengthened Spaniards' nationalist resistance against the perceived illegitimacy of Napoleon's rule.
 - (D) They convinced Spaniards that their country needed to overthrow its monarchy and establish a republican government.

Questions 12–14 refer to the passage below.

“The single and undisguised object of the League is to put down commercial monopoly; but that cannot be done by saddling upon our backs a fixed duty [tax] on imported corn [grain], which means a differential duty on sugar, on coffee, and monopoly in every other article. The Corn-law is the great tree of Monopoly, under whose baneful shadow every other restriction exists.

It is no fault of ours if with this agitation should be mixed up with the question of rents [paid by tenant farmers to large landowners], and should mingle in a degree that would render it difficult to separate the rights of property from the claims of those who labour under the grievance of these intolerable exactions. It is no fault of ours if the nobility of this country should become as much detested at their own baronial hall doors as were the noblesse of France previous to the Revolution. We are responsible for none of these things. The fault lies with those who support monopoly, who are deaf to reason and justice, and who place themselves upon a pedestal of injustice; a pedestal which is always liable to fall, and always certain to bring down those who stand upon it.

Free Trade! What is it? Why, breaking down the barriers that separate nations; those barriers, behind which nestle the feelings of pride, revenge, hatred, and jealousy, which every now and then burst their bounds, and deluge whole countries with blood; those feelings which nourish the poison of war and conquest, which assert that without conquest we can have no trade, which foster that lust for conquest and dominion which sends forth your warrior chiefs to scatter devastation through other lands, and then calls them back only to harass and oppress you at home.”

Richard Cobden, politician and manufacturer,
speech to the anti-Corn Law League, 1843

12. Based on the passage, Cobden would most likely have been associated with which of the following nineteenth-century ideologies?
- (A) Liberalism
 - (B) Anarchism
 - (C) Utopian socialism
 - (D) Conservatism
13. Which of the following conclusions about the economic and political structure of Great Britain is best supported by the passage?
- (A) Imperial expansion was extremely unpopular among British elites.
 - (B) In spite of parliamentary reforms, radical political revolution was widely supported by the bourgeoisie.
 - (C) Mercantilist economic policies were widely supported by the British working class.
 - (D) Despite changes brought about by industrialization, landed elites still retained significant power.

14. The eventual adoption of Cobden's ideas by the British government contributed most directly to which of the following developments in the late nineteenth century?
- (A) The increase in social tensions between the land-owning aristocracy and other classes in Great Britain
 - (B) The growth of a global economic network
 - (C) The increasing incidence of famine due to decreased food production in Great Britain
 - (D) The rising desire for national self-determination among ethnic minorities

Questions 15–17 refer to the passage below.

“I have a family of nine, and what did I have before the kolkhoz [collective farm]? I had all the produce I needed to feed my family, and fuel, and I clothed and shod them. Had a horse and three head of sheep. Delivered to the government twenty poods [1 pood = about 36 pounds] of rye, forty poods of millet, oats, potatoes, and hemp. I have worked on the kolkhoz, I have honestly earned 355 labor-days, but I no longer eat bread, but husks and potatoes, we don’t have enough to resole our shoes. My children have turned black from malnutrition. Respected editors, is there no way to leave the kolkhoz rather than perish here?”

A.P. Kokurin, Russian farmer, letter to *Izvestia*,
the official newspaper of the Soviet government,
from the Soviet province of Mordoviya, 1932

15. Which of the following groups was the policy described in the passage designed to eliminate?
- (A) Disloyal military officers
 - (B) Romanov monarchist sympathizers
 - (C) Landowning kulaks
 - (D) Ethnic Germans
16. Which of the following was the most significant factor behind the Russian government’s creation of the collective farms described by the author?
- (A) The need to address a high unemployment rate
 - (B) The need for rapid economic modernization
 - (C) The need to boost military spending
 - (D) The need to provide more foodstuffs for the Russian peasantry
17. Based on the context of the passage, what was the most likely fate of Kokurin and his family after he sent the letter?
- (A) They were either exiled to a gulag or executed.
 - (B) They were rewarded as loyal communists.
 - (C) They were allowed to emigrate from the Soviet Union.
 - (D) They were given back ownership of their farm.

PART B: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTION WITH PRIMARY SOURCE

The following is an example of short-answer question 2 found on the AP Exam. Note that on the actual AP Exam, students will answer three short-answer questions.

2. Use the image below to answer all parts of the question that follows.

**Xavier Badia-Vilatò, Spanish artist,
poster produced for Spanish anarchist group, 1936**



The text of the poster reads: Ambition, Militarism, War. This is Fascism. Unite to Destroy It.

- (A) Describe the historical situation in Spain reflected in the poster.
- (B) Describe one way in which the poster reflects broader historical developments in Europe.
- (C) Explain one way in which the artist's political affiliation influenced the view expressed in the poster.

Section II

The following are examples of the kinds of free-response questions found on the exam. Note that on the actual AP Exam, students will answer one document-based question and will select one of the three long essay questions to answer.

DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

1. Evaluate whether the Thirty Years' War was fought primarily for religious or primarily for political reasons.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.
- Use at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument about the prompt.
- For at least two documents, explain how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Document 1

Source: Holy Roman Emperor Matthias, open letter to his Protestant subjects in Bohemia, 1618

It has been alleged that the free exercise of religion will be abolished. We want to make it clear to you through this open letter that we have no intention of rescinding the agreement between the religions, still less want anyone else to do this, despite what others in Bohemia may have said. Moreover, we have always intended, and still intend, to preserve all the Bohemian privileges, liberties, and treaties. Anyone who claims otherwise slanders us before God and the world. Rest assured, dear obedient, loyal, and true Bohemian subjects, and do not give credence to such falsehoods. We would like nothing more than to return in person to our royal throne and residence amongst our loyal and obedient subjects and inhabitants and clear up these misunderstandings with God's help. However, we cannot come to our Bohemian territories at the moment, partly through poor health, but also pressure of other important affairs. Capable and prominent individuals will be appointed to clear up this misunderstanding. Since no enemy threatens us as ruler of Bohemia, there are no constitutional grounds to raise soldiers to defend the country, and thus no grounds for anyone, whoever, they might be, to use the territorial privileges, letters of majesty, ordinances, freedoms, or laws to justify arming.

Document 2

Source: Selections from the constitution of the Bohemian Federation, a coalition of nobles and city governments, 1619

Since the Almighty has also given his grace and blessing as this Confederation is solely in defense of religion, the territories have agreed that each and every one of their coreligionists should follow a Christian life according to the Calvinist teaching and faith, avoid and prevent sin, vice, public trouble, hypocrisy, in whatever form, and follow strictly the admonishments from the pulpit and the authorities. . . .

All churches in these united territories currently in Calvinist hands are to remain so in perpetuity. . . .

The free exercise of Calvinist religion is extended to every man and woman in all united territories and towns regardless as to whether they belong to the king or queen, permitting the construction of churches, schools, and cemeteries, and the appointment of Calvinist pastors and schoolteachers. Everyone shall be allowed to follow the old ceremonies of their Christian conscience in their own church. However, to ensure better unity and to prevent all kinds of difficulties and bitterness, there are to be no insults or personal attacks from the pulpit upon pain of removal from office. . . .

Should, contrary to hope, a king attempt anything contravening the religious concessions, unions, and this constitution, and thereby force the territories to take defensive measures, then all of these united kingdoms and provinces are released from their duty and cannot be subsequently held to account for any insults to the royal sovereignty and majesty.

Document 3

Source: Bernhard Baumann, Jesuit official in Heidelberg, report to Elector Maximilian of Bavaria on efforts to re-Catholicize previously Protestant areas after the Catholic victory in that region, 1628

Four hundred in the town and 1,200 outside it have been freed from heresy; on feast days we get around 700 communicants in the Church of the Holy Spirit. We alone look after parish duties, visit the sick and converts daily, conduct catechism inside the town and outside, and deliver two sermons on Sundays. These crowds are gathered with great difficulty; since only six months ago the richer townspeople were so obstinate, that two or three hundred declared they would emigrate if they were forced to convert. Then entire districts (they had arranged this in advance) declared they would keep the faith of their ancestors, because we could not steal this like other possessions. Since the orders arrived from Munich [to intensify Catholic conversions] they have used unbelievable deceptions to try to circumvent these. Furthermore, they complain to the Holy Roman Emperor, but the secular government, to its undying credit, knew how to stop this.

Document 4

Source: Letter from Gustavus Adolphus, king of Sweden, to the Protestant elector of Brandenburg, 1630

I have come into this land for no other purpose than to free it from the thieves and robbers who have so plagued it, and, first and foremost, to help his Excellency [the elector] out of his difficulties. Does his Excellency then not know that the [Holy Roman] emperor and his followers do not mean to rest till the Protestant religion is wholly rooted out of the empire, and that his Excellency has nothing else to expect than being forced either to deny his religion or to leave his country? Does he think by prayers and pleas and such like means to obtain something different? . . . I seek not my own advantage in this war, nor any gain save the security of my kingdom; I can look for nothing but expense, hard work, trouble, and danger to life and limb.

I tell you plainly that I will know nor hear nothing of “neutrality”; his Excellency must be either friend or foe. When I reach his frontier he must declare himself either hot or cold. The fight is between God and the devil. If his Excellency is on God’s side, let him stand by me; if he holds rather with the devil, then he must fight with me; there is no third course, that is certain.

Document 5

Source: Confidential account of a meeting between Axel Oxenstierna, Swedish high chancellor, and Sweden’s ally Brandenburg after the death of Gustavus Adolphus, 1633

Concerning the late Gustavus Adolphus’ intentions:

They were, in general, to disrupt the plans of the enemy, whose intentions with regards to the Baltic Sea are sufficiently well-known. His Majesty therefore intended to ensure the safety of his kingdom and the Baltic region, and liberate the oppressed lands [of Germany]; and thereafter to proceed according as events might develop: it was no part of his original intention to march as far into Germany as he did. He saw and clearly understood where that would lead, but the enemy and the circumstances compelled this. His majesty was there in person wherever the greatest danger was.

Document 6

Source: Jean Gagniere, “The elimination of heresy, and of rebellion, through the care of Cardinal Richelieu,” France, 1640. Richelieu, the chief minister of France, removes caterpillars representing Protestant Huguenots from the fleur-de-lis, the symbol of France, while the lion and eagle, representing Catholic Spain and Austria, are kept restrained by chains.



Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris, France/Bridgeman Images

Document 7

Source: Pope Innocent X, papal declaration in response to the treaty of Westphalia, 1648

Consumed by zeal for the house of the Lord, we endeavor everywhere to maintain the integrity and the authority of the Catholic Church, so that the ecclesiastical rights of which we have been appointed guardian by our Savior shall not in any way be impaired by those who seek their own interest rather than God's, and that we may not be accused of negligence when we shall render account to God. Accordingly it is not without deep pain that we have learned that by several articles in the peace concluded at [Westphalia], between our very dear son in Christ, Ferdinand, king of the Romans and emperor elect, on the one hand, and the Swedes, as well as our very dear son in Jesus Christ, Louis, the very Christian king of the French, on the other, great prejudice has been done to the Catholic religion, the divine service, the Roman apostolic see, the ecclesiastical order, their jurisdictions, authority, immunities, liberties, exemptions, privileges, possessions, and rights. . .

Accordingly we assert and declare that all the articles in the treaty which in any way impair . . . the Catholic religion, divine worship, or the salvation of souls . . . have been, and are of right, and shall perpetually be, null and void . . . even when they be ratified by oath.

LONG ESSAY QUESTION

The following is an example of a long essay question. Free-response questions 2, 3, and 4 in Section II of the AP Exam are long essay questions, and students will select one question of the three to answer.

2. Evaluate the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution during the period 1815 to 1900.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
- Use historical reasoning (e.g., comparison, causation, continuity or change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Skill	Learning Objective
1	C	3.A	Unit 2: Learning Objective B
2	C	4.A	Unit 2: Learning Objective B
3	B	4.B	Unit 2: Learning Objective B
4	C	4.B	Unit 2: Learning Objective C
5	B	5.A	Unit 1: Learning Objective M
6	B	1.B	Unit 1: Learning Objective M
7	C	2.C	Unit 1: Learning Objective M
8	C	3.A	Unit 4: Learning Objective G
9	A	2.B	Unit 4: Learning Objective A
10	A	3.A	Unit 4: Learning Objective G
11	C	5.A	Unit 5: Learning Objective G
12	A	2.A	Unit 5: Learning Objective I
13	D	4.A	Unit 6: Learning Objective F
14	B	5.A	Unit 6: Learning Objective C
15	C	1.A	Unit 8: Learning Objective G
16	B	1.B	Unit 8: Learning Objective G
17	A	4.A	Unit 8: Learning Objective G

Short-Answer Question	Skill	Learning Objective
2	2.B, 4.B, 2.C	Unit 8: Learning Objective H

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skill	Thematic Focus	Learning Objective
1	Document-based	4.A, 6.A, 6.B, 6.C, 6.D	SOP, CID	Unit 2: Learning Objectives B, C, D
2	Long essay	4.A, 6.A, 6.B, 6.C, 6.D	SOP, SCD, NEI	Unit 5: Learning Objectives E, F, G Unit 6: Learning Objectives F, G, I Unit 7: Learning Objectives A, C, D

The scoring information for the questions within this course and exam description, along with further exam resources, can be found on the [AP European History Exam Page](#) on AP Central.

AP History Rubrics

Introductory notes:

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of the rubric is earned independently. For instance, a student could earn a point for evidence beyond the documents without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- Accuracy: The components of this rubric each require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, a response may contain errors that do not detract from its overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- Clarity: Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and reasoning processes described in the rubrics.

AP History DBQ Rubric (7 points)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
A. THESIS/CLAIM (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.	<i>To earn this point, the thesis must make a claim that responds to the prompt rather than restating or rephrasing the prompt. The thesis must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion.</i>
B. CONTEXTUALIZATION (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the prompt that are relevant to the topic. This point is not awarded for merely a phrase or reference.</i>

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
C. EVIDENCE (0–3 pts)	Evidence From the Documents	<i>To earn one point, the response must accurately describe — rather than simply quote — the content from at least three of the documents.</i>
	1 pt. Uses the content of at least three documents to address the topic of the prompt. OR 2 pts. Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.	<i>To earn two points, the response must accurately describe — rather than simply quote — the content from at least four documents. In addition, the response must use the content of the four documents to support an argument in response to the prompt.</i>
	Evidence Beyond the Documents	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe the evidence and must use more than a phrase or reference. This additional piece of evidence must be different from the evidence used to earn the point for contextualization.</i>
	1 pt. Uses at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.	

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
D. ANALYSIS AND REASONING (0–2 pts)	1 pt. For at least two documents, explains how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.	To earn this point, the response must explain how or why (rather than simply identifying) the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, or audience is relevant to an argument about the prompt for each of the two documents sourced.
	1 pt. Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.	A response may demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. A response may demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Effectively using seven documents to support an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Explaining how the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience of at least four documents supports an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using documents and evidence beyond the documents effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt. This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.

AP History Long Essay Question Rubric

AP History LEQ Rubric (6 points)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
A. THESIS/CLAIM (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.	<i>To earn this point, the thesis must make a claim that responds to the prompt, rather than restating or rephrasing the prompt. The thesis must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion.</i>
B. CONTEXTUALIZATION (0–1 pt)	1 pt. Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the prompt that are relevant to the topic. This point is not awarded for merely a phrase or a reference.</i>
C. EVIDENCE (0–2 pts)	1 pt. Provides specific examples of at least two pieces of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt. OR 2 pts. Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.	<i>To earn one point, the response must identify specific historical examples relevant to the topic of the prompt.</i> <i>To earn two points the response must use specific historical evidence to support an argument in response to the prompt.</i>

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		Decision Rules
D. ANALYSIS AND REASONING (0–2 pts)	1 pt. Uses historical reasoning (e.g. comparison, causation, CCOT) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	OR 2 pts. Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.	To earn the first point, the response must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity. To earn the second point, the response may demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. A response may demonstrate a complex or nuanced understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence (at least four) support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt. This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.



Scoring Guidelines

Part B: Short-Answer Question with Primary Source

1. Use the image below to answer all parts of the question that follows.

Xavier Badia-Vilatò, Spanish artist,
poster produced for Spanish anarchist group, 1936



The text of the poster reads: Ambition, Militarism, War. This is Fascism. Unite to Destroy It.

- (A) Describe the historical situation in Spain reflected in the poster.
- (B) Describe one way in which the poster reflects broader historical developments in Europe.
- (C) Explain one way in which the artist's political affiliation influenced the view expressed in the poster.

General Scoring Notes

- Each point is earned independently.
- **Accuracy:** These scoring guidelines require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, responses may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam responses should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and reasoning processes described below.
- **Describe:** Provide the relevant characteristics of a specified topic. Description requires more than simply mentioning an isolated term.
- **Explain:** Provide information about how or why a historical development or process occurs or how or why a relationship exists.

Scoring Guidelines for Part B: Short-Answer Question with Primary Sources

3 points

- (a) Describe the historical situation in Spain reflected in the poster. **1 point**

Credited responses must describe some aspect of the Spanish political situation during the period of the Spanish Civil War, and do more than simply mention the word “Anarchism” or “Fascism.”

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Rise of radical leftist groups in Spain inspired by the Bolshevik Revolution.
- Growth of the Fascist movement in Spain led by Franco.
- Conflict between conservatives led by Franco and a coalition of leftist groups supporting the republic.

- (b) Describe one way in which the poster reflects broader historical developments in Europe. **1 point**

Credited responses must describe broader historical developments in Europe and do more than simply mentioning fascism, Nazism, or communism.

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Growing influence of Nazi and Fascist political ideologies in Europe.
- The influence of communist and anarchist thought on Europe after the Bolshevik Revolution.
- Effects of the Great Depression leading to political radicalism.
- Political tensions growing in Europe leading up to the Second World War.
- Fascist use of militaristic nationalism to win support of the population.
- Growing postwar bitterness as the catalyst for extreme political developments

- (c) Explain one way in which the artist’s political affiliation influenced the view expressed in the poster. **1 point**

Credited responses must explain a connection between the artist opinion of fascism and the basic tenets of anarchism.

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Anarchists believed that people should be free from government control, while fascists believed in government asserting control over many aspects of people’s daily lives.
- Anarchists were heavily influenced by Marxist thought, which the fascist and Nazi movements strongly opposed.
- Franco’s nationalists drew on Spain’s Catholic and monarchical traditions, which the anarchist movement rejected.

Total for Part B (Question 1) 3 points

Document-Based Question

1. Evaluate whether the Thirty Years' War was fought primarily for religious or primarily for political reasons.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.
- Use at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument about the prompt.
- For at least two documents, explain how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Document 1

Source: Holy Roman Emperor Matthias, open letter to his Protestant subjects in Bohemia, 1618

It has been alleged that the free exercise of religion will be abolished. We want to make it clear to you through this open letter that we have no intention of rescinding the agreement between the religions, still less want anyone else to do this, despite what others in Bohemia may have said. Moreover, we have always intended, and still intend, to preserve all the Bohemian privileges, liberties, and treaties. Anyone who claims otherwise slanders us before God and the world. Rest assured, dear obedient, loyal, and true Bohemian subjects, and do not give credence to such falsehoods. We would like nothing more than to return in person to our royal throne and residence amongst our loyal and obedient subjects and inhabitants and clear up these misunderstandings with God's help. However, we cannot come to our Bohemian territories at the moment, partly through poor health, but also pressure of other important affairs. Capable and prominent individuals will be appointed to clear up this misunderstanding. Since no enemy threatens us as ruler of Bohemia, there are no constitutional grounds to raise soldiers to defend the country, and thus no grounds for anyone, whoever, they might be, to use the territorial privileges, letters of majesty, ordinances, freedoms, or laws to justify arming.

Document 2

Source: Selections from the constitution of the Bohemian Federation, a coalition of nobles and city governments, 1619

Since the Almighty has also given his grace and blessing as this Confederation is solely in defense of religion, the territories have agreed that each and every one of their coreligionists should follow a Christian life according to the Calvinist teaching and faith, avoid and prevent sin, vice, public trouble, hypocrisy, in whatever form, and follow strictly the admonishments from the pulpit and the authorities. . . .

All churches in these united territories currently in Calvinist hands are to remain so in perpetuity. . . .

The free exercise of Calvinist religion is extended to every man and woman in all united territories and towns regardless as to whether they belong to the king or queen, permitting the construction of churches, schools, and cemeteries, and the appointment of Calvinist pastors and schoolteachers. Everyone shall be allowed to follow the old ceremonies of their Christian conscience in their own church. However, to ensure better unity and to prevent all kinds of difficulties and bitterness, there are to be no insults or personal attacks from the pulpit upon pain of removal from office. . . .

Should, contrary to hope, a king attempt anything contravening the religious concessions, unions, and this constitution, and thereby force the territories to take defensive measures, then all of these united kingdoms and provinces are released from their duty and cannot be subsequently held to account for any insults to the royal sovereignty and majesty.

Document 3

Source: Bernhard Baumann, Jesuit official in Heidelberg, report to Elector Maximilian of Bavaria on efforts to re-Catholicize previously Protestant areas after the Catholic victory in that region, 1628

Four hundred in the town and 1,200 outside it have been freed from heresy; on feast days we get around 700 communicants in the Church of the Holy Spirit. We alone look after parish duties, visit the sick and converts daily, conduct catechism inside the town and outside, and deliver two sermons on Sundays. These crowds are gathered with great difficulty; since only six months ago the richer townspeople were so obstinate, that two or three hundred declared they would emigrate if they were forced to convert. Then entire districts (they had arranged this in advance) declared they would keep the faith of their ancestors, because we could not steal this like other possessions. Since the orders arrived from Munich [to intensify Catholic conversions] they have used unbelievable deceptions to try to circumvent these. Furthermore, they complain to the Holy Roman Emperor, but the secular government, to its undying credit, knew how to stop this.

Document 4

Source: Letter from Gustavus Adolphus, king of Sweden, to the Protestant elector of Brandenburg, 1630

I have come into this land for no other purpose than to free it from the thieves and robbers who have so plagued it, and, first and foremost, to help his Excellency [the elector] out of his difficulties. Does his Excellency then not know that the [Holy Roman] emperor and his followers do not mean to rest till the Protestant religion is wholly rooted out of the empire, and that his Excellency has nothing else to expect than being forced either to deny his religion or to leave his country? Does he think by prayers and pleas and such like means to obtain something different? . . . I seek not my own advantage in this war, nor any gain save the security of my kingdom; I can look for nothing but expense, hard work, trouble, and danger to life and limb.

I tell you plainly that I will know nor hear nothing of “neutrality”; his Excellency must be either friend or foe. When I reach his frontier he must declare himself either hot or cold. The fight is between God and the devil. If his Excellency is on God’s side, let him stand by me; if he holds rather with the devil, then he must fight with me; there is no third course, that is certain.

Document 5

Source: Confidential account of a meeting between Axel Oxenstierna, Swedish high chancellor, and Sweden’s ally Brandenburg after the death of Gustavus Adolphus, 1633

Concerning the late Gustavus Adolphus’ intentions:

They were, in general, to disrupt the plans of the enemy, whose intentions with regards to the Baltic Sea are sufficiently well-known. His Majesty therefore intended to ensure the safety of his kingdom and the Baltic region, and liberate the oppressed lands [of Germany]; and thereafter to proceed according as events might develop: it was no part of his original intention to march as far into Germany as he did. He saw and clearly understood where that would lead, but the enemy and the circumstances compelled this. His majesty was there in person wherever the greatest danger was.

Document 6

Source: Jean Gagniere, “The elimination of heresy, and of rebellion, through the care of Cardinal Richelieu,” France, 1640. Richelieu, the chief minister of France, removes caterpillars representing Protestant Huguenots from the fleur-de-lis, the symbol of France, while the lion and eagle, representing Catholic Spain and Austria, are kept restrained by chains.



Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris, France/Bridgeman Images

Document 7

Source: Pope Innocent X, papal declaration in response to the treaty of Westphalia, 1648

Consumed by zeal for the house of the Lord, we endeavor everywhere to maintain the integrity and the authority of the Catholic Church, so that the ecclesiastical rights of which we have been appointed guardian by our Savior shall not in any way be impaired by those who seek their own interest rather than God's, and that we may not be accused of negligence when we shall render account to God. Accordingly it is not without deep pain that we have learned that by several articles in the peace concluded at [Westphalia], between our very dear son in Christ, Ferdinand, king of the Romans and emperor elect, on the one hand, and the Swedes, as well as our very dear son in Jesus Christ, Louis, the very Christian king of the French, on the other, great prejudice has been done to the Catholic religion, the divine service, the Roman apostolic see, the ecclesiastical order, their jurisdictions, authority, immunities, liberties, exemptions, privileges, possessions, and rights. . .

Accordingly we assert and declare that all the articles in the treaty which in any way impair . . . the Catholic religion, divine worship, or the salvation of souls . . . have been, and are of right, and shall perpetually be, null and void . . . even when they be ratified by oath.

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below.

Evaluate whether the Thirty Years' War was fought primarily for religious or primarily for political reasons.

Document-Based Question, Causes of the Thirty Years' War

7 points

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A Thesis/Claim (0-1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Are not historically defensible. - Only restate or rephrase the prompt. - Do not respond to the prompt. - Do not establish a line of reasoning. - Are overgeneralized.	Responses that earn this point: Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about whether the Thirty Years' War was primarily fought for religious or political reasons. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Provide a historically defensible claim, but do not establish a line of reasoning "The Thirty Years' War was fought for political but primarily religious reasons." "The Thirty Years' War was fought for religious and for political reasons. It is hard to determine the most significant because the two go together hand in hand."	Examples that earn this point: Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt "The Thirty Years' War was fought mostly for religious reasons because both Catholic and Protestant leaders wanted the freedom for their people to practice their faith without persecution." Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories "While the Thirty Years' War was religious in that it was fought to protect the freedom of religion throughout the Holy Roman Empire, it was also political in that it was used to strategically help certain powers protect themselves and stay prominent." - The Thirty Years' War was fought overwhelming for religious purposes, with countries being drawn into war to defend the sanctity of one religion or another, and always divided Catholics and Protestants." Establish a line of reasoning "The Thirty Years' War was primarily fought over religion and all stemmed from a little squabble in Bohemia." (<i>Minimally acceptable thesis/claim</i>)
Additional Notes: - The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). - The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization (0-1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. - Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. - Provide a passing phrase or reference.	Responses that earn this point: Accurately describe a context relevant to whether the Thirty Years' War was fought for primarily political or religious reasons
	Examples that do not earn this point: Do not provide context relevant to the topic of the prompt <i>"The Thirty Years' War sparked large amounts of disruption in Europe and it involved primarily the French Huguenots and the Holy Roman Empire (Catholics) but other European countries were involved."</i>	Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - Earlier Protestant-Catholic conflicts - Protestant and Catholic Reformations - Habsburg vs. French dynastic rivalries - Religious conflict in England - The Peace of Augsburg - The Edict of Nantes - Jesuits and the Catholic Reformation - Fragmentation of the Holy Roman Empire - Huguenots and French wars of religion - Emergence of Lutheranism and Calvinism - Increasing power of monarchies - Defenestration of Prague Examples of acceptable contextualization: <i>"Prior to the Thirty Years' War period, Luther had been spreading his ideas of Protestantism and individual interpretation of the Bible. As a result, European states were divided without the Catholic Church holding them together. The religious tension, primarily between the Holy Roman Empire and France, marked the period prior to the Thirty Years' War."</i> <i>"During the Thirty Years' War the Peace of Augsburg was taken away. In the Peace of Augsburg it states that the leader of the country can choose to have a Protestant or Catholic country. This was taking away people's freedom and religious toleration.... Cardinal Richelieu from France did not like the idea of Huguenots gaining power because they were Protestant."</i> <i>The Protestant and Catholic Reformations created enormous tension over religion prior to the Thirty Years' War that affected things on a national scale and on an individual scale. (Minimally acceptable contextualization)</i>
Additional Notes: - The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. - To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C Evidence (0-3 points)	Evidence from the Documents		
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses the content of at least three documents to address the topic of the prompt.	2 points Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least four documents.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - Use evidence from less than three of the documents - Misinterpret the content of the document - Quote, without an accompanying description, of the content of the documents - Address documents collectively rather than considering separately the content of each document	Responses that earn 1 point: Accurately describe — rather than simply quote — the content from at least three of the documents to address the topic of motivations for the Thirty Years' War.	Responses that earn 2 points: Support an argument in response to the prompt by accurately using the content of at least four documents.
		Examples of describing the content of a document: Describe evidence from the documents relevant to the topic but do not use that evidence to support an argument (Document 6): "In 1640 the Thirty Years War had reached the 'French Phase.' This phase was known as one of the bloodiest phases to exist. Jean Gagniere paints Richelieu carefully removing the French Calvinists (Huguenots) from France. Gagniere paints Catholic Austria and Spain as chained back but vicious." (Document 7): "In Doc 7 is the signing of the Treaty of Westphalia which is known to be the signing that ended religious conflicts. Pope Innocent X responds on how the authority of the Catholic church should not prevent you from seeking other interests other than God."	Examples of supporting an argument using the content of a document: (Document 1): "The Holy Roman Emperor attempted to convince others that he wasn't motivated to start a war because of religion, since he doesn't plan on altering religious policies. However this is wholly untrue since the Holy Roman emperor continues to be a Catholic power." <i>(Uses evidence from the document to support an argument about real vs. asserted motivations for the Thirty Years' War)</i> (Document 4): "However the war was in fact religiously motivated. In a letter from Gustavus Adolphus to the elector of Brandenburg, Adolphus declares that the HR Emperor only wants to root out the Protestant religion." <i>(Uses evidence from the document to support an argument about the strong religious motivations for the Thirty Years' War)</i> - In a paragraph arguing for political motivations, Holy Roman Emperor Matthias (Document 1) is referenced as seeking to regain his throne in Bohemia and to dilute tensions there, while Swedish King Adolphus (Document 4) is used in reference to his intent to keep a lasting peace in the Baltic region, and finally, Swedish Chancellor Oxenstierna (Document 5) is used as evidence in reference to Swedish political motivations for entering the war. <i>(Describes and connects the content of the documents to an argument about the complicated political motivations for the Thirty Years' War)</i>
	Additional Notes: To earn two points, the four documents do not have to be used in support of a single argument—they can be used across sub-arguments or to address counterarguments.		

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row C (continued)	Evidence beyond the Documents:	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses at least one additional piece of specific historical evidence (beyond that found in the documents) relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide evidence that is not relevant to an argument about the prompt. - Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. - Repeat information that is specified in the prompt or in any of the documents. - Provide a passing phrase or reference.	Responses that earn this point: Must use at least one specific piece of historical evidence relevant to an argument about the primary motivation of fighting the Thirty Years' War.
		Examples of specific and relevant evidence beyond the documents that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - The Hapsburg Rulers - Defenestration of Prague - Bohemian Revolt - Louis XIII - Christian IV - Dutch Republic - Sigismund Examples of evidence beyond the documents relevant to an argument about the prompt: <i>"When messengers arrived bearing news that the emperor had lied in the document, the townspeople responded by throwing the messengers out the window in the infamous Defenestration of Prague." (Uses a piece of evidence beyond the documents to make a connection to an argument about the prompt)</i> <i>"Richelieu was responsible for convincing King Louis to enter the war, seeing it as a way to extend French power. Richelieu's ambitions were successful, as the war severely weakened the Holy Roman Empire, and cemented France as the dominant European power." (Uses a piece of evidence beyond the documents to make a connection about the prompt)</i>
	Additional Notes: - Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. - To earn this point, the evidence provided must be different from the evidence used to earn the point for contextualization. - To earn this point, the evidence provided must be more than a phrase or reference. - The point for evidence beyond the documents may be awarded for evidence that appears in any part of the response.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row D Analysis and Reasoning (0-2 points)	Sourcing	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point For at least two documents, explains how or why the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience is relevant to an argument.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Explain sourcing for fewer than two of the documents. - Identify the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience but fail to explain how or why it is relevant to an argument. - Summarize the content or argument of the document without explaining the relevance of this summary to the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience.	Responses that earn this point: Must explain how or why — rather than simply identifying — the document's point of view, purpose, historical situation, or audience is relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt for each of the two documents sourced.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Identify the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience, but do not explain how or why it is relevant to an argument "In document 5, the audience is a private person because it is a letter." Summarize the content of the document without explaining the relevance of this to the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience "The purpose of this document was to make a strong statement about the Pope's views."	Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the author's point of view: (Document 3): "When this letter was written in 1628, religious tensions were still high. As a Jesuit, Baumann was a militant Catholic and held great disdain for Protestants." (Connects the point of view of the document relevant to an argument about the religious motivations for the war) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the author's purpose: (Document 4): "The King of Sweden wrote that he came into the Protectant elector's land to help free it from 'thieves and robbers' and that he would not recognize the elector's neutrality; a side must be chosen. The king was trying to intimidate the elector into supporting the Swedes to increase the amount of support for his cause." (Connects the purpose of the document to an argument about the mix of religious and political motivations) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the historical situation of a source: (Document 7): "Document 7 is an excerpt from Pope Innocent 10th denouncing all articles of religious freedom as noted in the Treaty of Westphalia. The Pope was not allowed to partake in the Westphalia agreement which signified a continent-wide severing of the relationship between church and state. For this reason, Pope Innocent's identity and historical situation in the balance of power at that time adds significance to his outraged and saddened tone in the response." (Connects the historical situation of the document relevant to an argument about the complex motivations for involvement the Thirty Years' War) Example of acceptable explanation of the relevance of the audience: (Document 5): "As a confidential account, document 5 likely offers an honest telling of Adolphus' motives and reveals that there were indeed political motives behind Adolphus' actions." (Connects the audience of the document relevant to an argument that discusses the political motivations for the war)

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row D (continued)	Complexity	
	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
		Responses that earn this point: May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Effectively using seven documents to support an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Explaining how the point of view, purpose, historical situation, and/or audience of at least four documents supports an argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using documents and evidence beyond the documents effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt.

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria
	Demonstrating complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - Exploring multiple themes, such as European leaders' willingness to use religious and political rationales to increase the power of the state. <i>(Explains nuance)</i> - Explaining that the Thirty Years' war had both religious and political reasons, but making a clear chronological demarcation between the two, arguing that the motivations for the war shifted from religious to political following the French entry into the war. <i>(Explains multiple causes or effects)</i> - Connecting to other time periods, such as contrasting Richelieu's treatment of Protestants in France with the ways that Philip used the Spanish Inquisition's to force the exodus of Spanish Jews who did not convert to Christianity. <i>(Explains relevant and insightful connections)</i> - Acknowledging that Cardinal Richelieu in Document 6 is achieving political gains and using religion as an excuse. As a politique he is willing to disregard his religious beliefs in favor of the state. He is killing two birds with one stone by removing Huguenots and increasing unity in France. Along with Adolphus, these leaders are extending the security of their states and increasing their power. This demonstrates how a ruler can use religious and political motivations to achieve their goal of increasing the power of the state, and therefore an understanding of broader historical developments behind the document. <i>(Explains nuance)</i> - Discussing both religious and political reasons but making a clear chronological demarcation between the two. The transition is based on the intervention of France and Sweden into the conflict. The response uses Document 1 (Emperor is trying to comfort and pacify the agitation) and Document 2 (Bohemia's response ...defending its right to practice Calvinism). A discussion of religious reasons is followed by an analysis of Documents 4, 5, and 6 discussing Adolphus and France's intervention into the war. This develops the argument that the aims of Sweden and France changed the complexity of the war from religiously to politically motivated actions. <i>(Explains nuance through multiple variables)</i> - Establishing the argument that the true purpose of the Thirty Years' War was the gain of power. Document 1 is used to explain how Matthias tries to avoid alienating Protestants by allowing the free practice of religion, but in reality this is a façade to protect his own power by deterring the Bohemians from taking up arms. The response then corroborates this line of reasoning by suggesting that the coalition of Calvinist nobles and cities is deceptive in that its actual motivation is political rather than being based on religious freedom. This confirms the validity of the argument by showing the use of religion as a pretext for political motives from the differing perspective of a Catholic and a Protestant ruler. <i>(Corroborates an argument by considering diverse or alternative views or evidence)</i> - Supporting an argument that the Thirty Years' War can be connected to the Spanish Inquisition, the response uses Document 6 to contrast the relatively placid way that Richelieu removed Protestants from France with the violent way in which Philip forced the exodus of Spanish Jews who would not convert. The response continues by noting that Richelieu's approach is less violent than the treatment Huguenots could expect in Spain or Austria. <i>(Explains relevant and insightful connections)</i> Additional Notes: - This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. - While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference. - To earn a point for complexity by using seven documents in support of an argument, there must be an attempt to use all seven documents to effectively support an argument, but the use of the documents may be unevenly or inconsistently developed, or the document use may be weaker in one or two instances.

Document Summaries

Document	Summary of Content	Explains the relevance of point of view (POV), purpose, situation, and/or audience by elaborating on examples such as:
1. Emperor Matthias's letter to Bohemian Protestants (1618)	Claims he has no plans to rescind the free exercise of the Protestant religion in Bohemia, therefore there is no reason for Bohemia to take up arms	- Emperor wants to reassure Protestant subjects to prevent rebellion. (POV/situation) - Protestants in Bohemia feared the re-imposition of Catholicism by the Empire. (audience)
2. Constitution of the Bohemian Federation (1619)	Cites the need to defend Calvinism as the motivation for creating the Confederation	- Bohemian leaders are justifying their actions to take defensive measures if necessary. (POV) - Bohemians desire to protect the free exercise of Calvinism against Catholicism. (purpose)
3. Baumann report to the Elector Maximilian (1628)	Describes problems with re-imposing Catholicism in Protestant areas of Bavaria after the Habsburg victory there	- Habsburgs are winning the war against the Protestant German states and re-imposing Catholicism. (situation) - Jesuit official seeks to reassure the Elector that Catholicism is winning despite Protestant resistance. (purpose)
4. Letter from Adolphus to Elector of Brandenburg (1630)	Adolphus claims Swedish intervention is to prevent Catholic Habsburgs from wiping out German Protestantism	- Seeks to intimidate the elector into supporting the Swedes. (purpose) - Protestant king wants to support other Protestant princes in Germany. (POV)
5. Oxenstierna meeting notes (1633)	Notes that Sweden looked to secure the safety of Sweden and command of the Baltic Sea	- Oxenstierna justifies Adolphus' land acquisition. (POV) - Confidential meeting with allied government reveals political power (purpose)
6. Richelieu engraving (1640)	Portrays the Cardinal protecting France from Huguenot Protestants and rival Catholic powers	- Tries to influence political opinion as to the wisdom of Richelieu's policies (audience) - France is intervening on behalf of the Protestants in Germany to weaken the rival Habsburgs (situation)
7. Pope Innocent X declaration (1648)	Criticizes Peace of Westphalia and claims that it is not legitimate	- Sees the settlement as a defeat for the Catholic side (POV) - Chastises the Catholic rulers for putting secular interests ahead of faith (audience)

Long Essay Question

2. Evaluate the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution during the period 1815 to 1900.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
- Use historical reasoning (e.g., comparison, causation, continuity or change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.
- Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below.

Evaluate the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution during the period 1815 to 1900.

Long Essay Question, Effects of the French Revolution

6 points

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A Thesis/Claim (0-1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Are not historically defensible. - Only restate or rephrase the prompt. - Do not respond to the prompt. - Do not establish a line of reasoning. - Are overgeneralized.	Responses that earn this point: Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution during the period from 1815 to 1900. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: Do not provide a historically defensible thesis/claim <i>"The French Revolution was to improve the lives of all Europeans by giving them political rights."</i> Provide a restatement of the prompt <i>"The French Revolution had many effects all over Europe."</i> Do not respond to the prompt <i>"The most significant effect of the French Revolution was to give Napoleon the opportunity to come to power in France and attempt to conquer Europe."</i>	Examples that earn this point: Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt <i>"Although the French Revolution failed to establish a lasting democratic government in the short-term, it had significant long-term effects on the politics of post-Revolutionary Europe because it set up a republican government as a legitimate and attainable goal for future revolutionaries."</i> Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories <i>"The most important long-term effect of the French Revolution was to encourage Europe's political elite to attempt to prevent future revolutions. Sometimes this was done through repression, but increasingly, leaders sought to get ahead of revolutionary demands."</i> <i>The most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution was its failure to destroy the monarchical model of government. Although many of the goals of the Revolution would later be realized in different countries of Europe during the 1800s, this would generally happen under the direction of kings and emperors."</i> Establish a line of reasoning <i>"After 1815, the most important effect of the French Revolution was to inspire other Revolutions with similar goals such as the Revolutions of 1848." (Minimally acceptable thesis/claim)</i>
Additional Notes: - The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). - The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.		

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization (0-1 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: - Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. - Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. - Provide a passing phrase or reference. Examples that do not earn this point: Overly generalized attempt at contextualization <i>"There have been many revolutions in Europe, but none was more significant than the French Revolution that started in 1789."</i>	Responses that earn this point: - Accurately describe a context relevant to long-term effects of the French Revolution in the period 1815-1900. Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - Nationalist movements - Napoleonic Empire/fall of Napoleon - Concert of Europe - Enlightenment ideals of universal rights, equality, and popular government - The political goals of the revolutionaries in France in 1789 - The various phases of the French Revolution (liberal, Jacobin, Directory, Consulate) - Violence of the revolutionaries and its discrediting effects - The exposure of the weaknesses of Old Regime monarchies - Nationalist reactions to Napoleon's attempted conquests - The defeat of Napoleon by a conservative coalition of European monarchies. Example of acceptable contextualization: <i>"In 1815, the Revolution appeared to be over. Napoleon had been defeated, the French monarchy had been restored, and the conservative regimes that dominated Europe were determined to prevent any future uprisings."</i> <i>"Political thinkers of the Enlightenment had pioneered influential ideas like government by consent." (Minimally acceptable contextualization)</i>
	Additional Notes: - The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. - To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.	

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C Evidence (0-2 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Provides specific examples of at least two pieces of evidence relevant to the topic of the prompt.	2 points Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - Identify a single piece of evidence. - Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic of the prompt. - Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. - Repeat information that is specified in the prompt.	Responses that earn 1 point: <u>Identify at least two specific historical examples</u> relevant to the long-term effects of the French Revolution in the period 1815 to 1900.	Responses that earn 2 points: <u>Use at least two specific historical examples</u> to support an argument regarding the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution in the period 1815-1900.
	Examples that do not earn points: Provide evidence that is overly general: <i>"The French Revolution caused major changes, including social, political, and economic changes across France."</i>	Examples of evidence that are specific and relevant include the following (two examples required): - Revolutions of 1848 - Expansion of voting rights in France and Britain - Romantic portrayals of the Revolution in nineteenth-century art and literature - Metternich and the Concert of Europe - German student societies - Romantic imagery of the French Revolution - Expansion of voting rights in Britain (Chartist movement) - Garibaldi's "red-shirts" and attempts to unify Italy - Revolution of 1830 in France and the July Monarchy - Greek War of Independence - Frankfurt Parliament and Constitution (1848) - Revolution of 1848 in France and the Second Republic - Napoleon III and the Second Empire - Bismarck and universal male suffrage in Germany - Third Republic in France - Liberal-conservative conflicts in Spain (Carlist wars) Example of a statement that earns one point for evidence: <i>"The French people eventually overthrew the restored Bourbon monarchy in 1830 and created a constitutional monarchy, which was followed less than twenty years later in 1848 by another overthrow of the existing government that established the Second Republic."</i>	Examples that successfully support an argument with evidence: <i>"Revolutionary nationalists in 1848 seeking to unify Italy and Germany supported the ideals of liberty and universal citizenship that had first appeared in France during the Revolution." (Uses evidence to support an argument about how increased nationalism was the most significant effect of the French Revolution)</i> <i>"Metternich and other European leaders after the Congress of Vienna tried to suppress future revolutions by employing censorship and secret police. This shows the fear that the ideas of the French Revolution continued to inspire." (Uses evidence to support an argument about the continuing effect of the French Revolution)</i> <i>"Many nineteenth century revolutionaries were inspired by the French Revolution... In Italy, Garibaldi's movement used French Revolutionary slogans and symbols such as the tricolor flag." (Uses evidence to support an argument about the French Revolution's effect on subsequent revolutions)</i> <i>"Conservative rulers in the later 1800s could not completely ignore the demands for political rights that had begun during the French Revolution. Both Napoleon III's Second Empire and the new German Empire under Bismarck's leadership gave many people the right to vote, although neither was truly democratic." (Uses evidence to support an argument about the continuing influence of the French Revolution on European political systems in the later nineteenth century)</i>

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Row C (continued)	Additional Notes: • Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. • If a response has a multipart argument, then it can meet the threshold of two pieces of evidence by giving one example for one part of the argument and another example for a different part of the argument, but the total number of examples must still be at least two. (For example, the Congress of Vienna represented a return to conservatism as a response to the French Revolution’s radical threat; the ideals of the French Revolution could not be quelled, eventually serving as part of the inspiration for further 19th century revolutions in Europe and abroad.)
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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row D Analysis and Reasoning (0-2 points)	0 points Does not meet the criteria for one point.	1 point Uses historical reasoning (e.g. comparison, causation, continuity and change) to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	2 points Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: - May include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument. - May assert the use of historical reasoning but does not use it to frame or structure an argument.	Responses that earn 1 point: Must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument, that addresses the most significant long-term effect of the French Revolution. The reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity.	Responses that earn 2 points: May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: - Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR - Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR - Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR - Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways that might include: - Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence (at least four) support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR - Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt.

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Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
	Examples that do not earn points: Provide evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument “There were many different effects of the French Revolution.”	Using a historical reasoning process to frame or structure an argument could include: - Explaining nineteenth-century reactions to aspect of the French Revolution using causal reasoning. - Discussing effects of the French Revolution on different themes, such as economics, politics and culture. Example of acceptable use of historical reasoning: “The French Revolution led to a conservative reaction and then to subsequent attempts to restore political stability through military and social efforts.” <i>(Indicates a significant effect caused by the French Revolution)</i> “Nationalist unification movements in a number of European regions in the middle of the 19th century were inspired by the ideals of the French Revolution and through their won successes sparked further nationalist and independence movements over time.” <i>(Indicates a significant effect caused by the French Revolution)</i>	Demonstrating complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided: - Explaining different effects of the French Revolution in different regions of Europe. <i>(Explains nuance)</i> - Explaining changes in the effects of the French Revolution over the course of the nineteenth century. <i>(Provides insightful connections with and across periods)</i> - Considering the economic causes and effects of the French Revolution on Europe. <i>(Explains both cause and effect)</i> - Corroborating an argument about the effect of the French Revolution on Europe with cultural evidence (e.g. romantic portrayals of the French Revolution in art), political evidence (e.g. the Garibaldi Movement and the Chartist Movement). <i>(Uses evidence to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt)</i>
	Additional Notes: - To earn the first point for analysis and reasoning, the response must use historical reasoning to structure a response to the prompt, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking in specificity. - This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. - While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.		